

“Master Lie”), which is attributed to him, he writes of an ancient (even for him) encounter of King Mu of the Zhou dynasty with a rather brilliant engineer called Yan Shi, in around 950 BC! It is said that Yan Shi brought a creation of his to show off to the king. This creation was an artificial figure that walked and sang like a human, and even winked at the ladies present. The king was fooled, and furious. He ordered the execution of Shi and his companion, until Shi showed him that his companion was nothing more than a man-made construction of leather, wood and glue, and a lot of real internal organs.

Many people also attribute the very beginnings of our quest for AI to Greek, Chinese and Indian philosophers, who first started the world on the path of deductive reasoning and logic. Many say it's the logical approach to thinking that led to the formation of the sciences and mathematics, which is the very basis for all technology – from the humble PCs of today to the intelligent beings we're trying to create tomorrow. 